The Bayesian Portfolio — User Guide

Before you start

The Portfolio is automated trading software. It runs on your own Windows computer or VPS, connects to your MetaTrader 5 terminal, and places and manages trades on that account using four systematic strategies.

What it does

- Watches USDJPY, DE40 (DAX), UK100 (FTSE) and NAS100 (Nasdaq) on your broker's prices.
- Opens trades with a stop loss already set, sized to the risk you choose.
- Manages them: takes partial profit, moves stops to entry, and closes time-limited trades.
- Applies your safety limits: daily loss limit, daily trade limit and the optional weekend close.

What it does not do

- It doesn't give advice or manage your money. You choose the account, the risk and the settings.
- It doesn't touch trades you place yourself, or trades from other software.
- It can't guarantee profit or that you will pass a prop firm evaluation.

Risk. Trading leveraged products is high risk and most retail traders lose money. Results on our website are from backtesting unless labelled live. Expect losing days, weeks and months, and only risk money you can afford to lose. Read the full risk disclosure on bayesiansystems.io before you start.

What you need

Item	Why
A Windows VPS or PC that stays on	The bot only trades while it and MT5 are running
MetaTrader 5	The bot connects to it to read prices and place orders
A broker or prop firm account that allows automated trading	Check your firm's rules first (see Prop firm accounts)

Item	Why
Your licence key	From your Whop orders page after you sign up
15 minutes	For the setup below

Set up your VPS and MT5

Run the bot on a Windows VPS so it keeps trading when your own computer is off.

1. **Rent a Windows VPS.** 2 CPU cores and 4 GB of memory is enough. Choose a location close to your broker's servers (London is right for most UK and EU brokers). Connect with Remote Desktop: the free Windows App on Mac and iPad, or Remote Desktop Connection on Windows.
2. **Install MetaTrader 5 on the VPS.** Download it from your broker's website, so it opens already set up for their servers.
3. **Log in to your trading account** in MT5 (File → Login to Trade Account). The bot trades whichever account this MT5 is logged in to.
4. **Turn on Algo Trading.** Click the **Algo Trading** button in the MT5 toolbar so it turns green. If it's red, every order the bot sends is rejected.
5. **Allow enough price history.** Tools → Options → Charts → set **Max bars in chart** to at least 100000. Some cells look back up to a year.
6. **Stop Windows restarting by itself.** In Windows Update, set active hours or pause updates, so a surprise restart doesn't stop trading. If you do restart, the bot can start itself again (see Install and first run).

If you trade more than one account, install a separate copy of MT5 for each, in its own folder. Each copy of the bot uses one MT5.

Install and first run

The bot is a single file, **BayesianSystems.exe**. There is nothing else to install.

1. **Download it** on your VPS, from your Whop order (The Bayesian Portfolio → Software → Download), or directly: BayesianSystems.exe.
2. **If your browser blocks it.** Edge may say *"BayesianSystems.exe isn't commonly downloaded"*. Press **Ctrl + J**, click **…** next to the file, then **Keep → Show more → Keep anyway**. This happens with any new software and is safe to keep.
3. **Give it its own folder.** Create `C:\BayesianSystems` and move the file into it. The bot saves its settings, log and trade records next to itself, so keep it there.

4. **Run it.** Double-click it. If Windows shows "Windows protected your PC", click **More info → Run anyway**. The very first start can take up to a minute while Windows checks the file; after that it starts in seconds.
5. **Answer four questions** (first run only). Everything else, your MT5, your broker's symbol names and its server time zone, is found automatically.
   - **Licence key:** copy it from your Whop order (The Bayesian Portfolio → Software → Copy).
   - **Risk per trade:** percent of balance risked per trade. 0.5 is a sensible start.
   - **Account type:** Personal (live), Demo, or Prop firm. Prop firm switches on the standard prop rules (see Prop firm accounts).
   - **Telegram:** scan the QR code with your phone's camera, tap **START** in Telegram, then press Enter. You get a test message.
6. **Start automatically?** Answer **yes**, and the bot starts by itself whenever you log in to Windows.
7. **Leave the window open.** Closing it stops the bot. If the bot ever crashes or MT5 stops responding, it restarts itself after 30 seconds.

Check everything (optional): open Command Prompt in the bot's folder and run `BayesianSystems.exe --test`. It shows your account, the symbols it found, the server clock, your licence status and how much history each cell has. It places no trades. **Auto-start later:** if you said no during setup, run `BayesianSystems.exe --install-startup` once (undo with `--remove-startup`).

Updating: download the new version from the same link and replace the .exe in your folder. Your settings, licence and Telegram connection are kept.

Settings explained

Your settings live in **settings.ini**, next to the .exe. Open it in Notepad, change a value and save: the bot picks up the change within a minute and applies it from the next trade. Open trades keep the settings they were opened with. If you make a typo, the bot keeps the previous settings and tells you what was wrong. To answer the setup questions again, run `BayesianSystems.exe --setup`.

Setting	Default	What it does
`key`	(yours)	Your licence key. Changing it needs a restart.

Setting	Default	What it does
`terminal_path`	found for you	Which MT5 to use, if you have several. Blank = the one that is open.
`required_server_text`	blank	Safety: only trade if the MT5 server name contains this text, e.g. `OANDA`. Stops it trading the wrong account by mistake.
`risk_per_trade_pct`	0.5	Percent of your balance risked per trade, from 0.01 to 5.
`daily_loss_limit_pct`	0 (off); 4 for Prop firm	Stop opening trades for the day once the day's loss reaches this percent.
`daily_loss_basis`	balance; higher for Prop firm	Measure the day's loss from start-of-day `balance`, `equity`, or `higher` (the larger of the two, the safest choice).
`daily_reset_time` / `daily_reset_timezone`	00:00 London; 00:00 Prague for Prop firm	When your trading day resets. Most prop firms use midnight Prague time.
`close_trades_at_limit`	no; yes for Prop firm	`yes` also closes the bot's open trades when the daily limit is hit.
`daily_loss_buffer_pct`	20	Extra margin for slippage, spread and commission when sizing trades under the daily limit.
`max_trades_per_day`	0 (no limit)	Maximum new trades per day.
`close_before_weekend`	no; yes for Prop firm	`yes` closes all the bot's trades on Friday and opens none until the market reopens.

Setting	Default	What it does
`friday_close_ny_time`	16:30	The Friday cut-off, in New York time.
`bot_token` / `chat_id`	blank	Advanced: send to your own Telegram bot instead of ours. Leave blank to use the built-in connection (see Telegram).
`daily_summary_uk_time`	22:00	When the daily Telegram summary is sent, UK time. Blank = none.
`[symbols]`	blank	The bot finds your broker's names (GER40, DE40.raw, US100…). Fill these in only if it picks the wrong one.

How it trades

All four cells run together on one account. Every trade has a stop loss from the moment it opens, and its size is set so that hitting the stop loses your chosen risk.

Cell	Market	Style	Direction	How the trade is managed
A	USDJPY	Reversal, London session	Long and short	Opened as two halves. One half takes profit at 2R; the stop on the other half then moves to entry, and it targets 3R.
C	DE40, UK100	Mean reversion, European cash hours	Long only	One position with a stop and a target.
F	DE40	Momentum into the US open	Long and short	Stop, no target. The bot closes it at the 17:30 Frankfurt close.
G	NAS100	Breakout on busy days	Long only	Stop and a 3R target. The bot closes it if neither is hit within about five trading days.

R is the amount you risk on one trade. At 0.5% risk on a $50,000 account, 1R is $250.

Safety rules on every entry

- A signal more than 15 minutes old is never entered, for example after a restart.
- A trade is skipped if price has already moved more than 0.3R from the planned entry, or is through the stop or target.
- Lot sizes come from your broker's own contract details, so they're right for any account currency.
- Your daily loss limit, daily trade limit and weekend close are checked first.
- Every skipped trade is logged with the reason, and sent to Telegram if you use it.

What it never does: move a stop further away, add to a losing trade, or touch any position it didn't open. Its trades are tagged with its own magic number and a `BS` comment.

Prop firm accounts

Only run the bot on a prop firm account whose rules explicitly allow automated trading with third-party software. Some firms ban it outright, some need the software approved first, and rules change, so check your firm's current terms before you start. Running it where it isn't allowed can get the account closed and payouts refused.

Choosing "Prop firm account" in setup switches on standard prop rules:

- **Daily loss limit of 4%** (most firms allow 5%), measured from the higher of balance or equity at the start of the day, resetting at midnight Prague time. In backtests this limit was almost never reached.
- **If the limit is reached,** the bot closes its own open trades and opens nothing more until the next day.
- **Every trade is sized** so that even if all open trades hit their stops together, the 4% isn't broken.
- **No weekend holding:** trades are closed on Friday (16:30 New York time) and nothing opens until the market reopens.

If your firm's rules differ, for example a 3% daily limit or a different reset time, change them in settings.ini (see Settings explained). Keep your risk per trade at or below your firm's maximum.

How the daily loss limit protects you. Before every trade the bot adds up today's loss so far, every open trade hitting its stop, and the new trade hitting its stop, plus a 20% buffer for slippage and costs. If that could cross your limit, the new trade is made smaller to fit, or skipped. If the limit is still reached (for example by your own manual trades, or a price gap), the bot opens nothing more until your reset time.

It can't protect against a market gapping far past a stop, such as over a weekend or a major news event. On prop accounts, use the weekend close.

Consistency and copy-trading rules. Some firms limit how much of your profit can come from one day, or flag accounts that place identical trades to other accounts. Check these rules for your firm. If you run several accounts, a lower risk per account usually fits consistency rules better.

Your licence

One licence trades one MT5 account at a time. It becomes active on the first account the bot starts on; there's nothing to register.

Moving to another account. Start the bot on the new account. It asks:

> Your licence is active on account 51234567 (broker-live). Move it to this account? It will stop opening trades on the other account within 5 minutes.

Type **Y** and it moves straight away. Useful when a prop account ends and you start a new one. The bot checks in every 5 minutes, so the old account stops opening new trades shortly after. Trades already open there are left alone; manage or close them yourself.

Several accounts at once need one licence each.

Free trial. New subscribers get 14 days free on a **broker demo account**, so you can watch it trade without risking money. Trials don't run on live or prop firm accounts, and each MT5 account can trial once. You get an email before the trial ends. If you continue, the licence moves automatically to the first live account you run it on.

If the licence can't be checked (for example your internet drops), the bot keeps working for 24 hours, then pauses new trades until it can check again.

Cancelling. Cancel any time from your Whop account. The licence stays active to the end of the period you've paid for. After that the bot stops opening new trades, but never closes your open ones.

Telegram activity log

Optional, but recommended. The bot messages you on Telegram every time it does something, so you can follow it from your phone. Messages come from the Bayesian Systems Telegram bot and contain your bot's activity only.

Set it up (1 minute)

1. During setup, the bot shows a QR code and a link.

2. Scan the QR code with your phone's camera, or open the link. Telegram opens the Bayesian Systems bot.
3. Tap **START** in Telegram, then press Enter in the bot's window. You get a test message.

Skipped it, or changed phone? Run `BayesianSystems.exe --telegram` in the bot's folder at any time. To stop the messages, send `/stop` to the Telegram bot.

What you'll receive

- Trades opened: market, direction, lots, entry, stop, target and risk in money.
- Trades closed, with the result in money and R.
- Stops moved to entry, time exits and weekend closes.
- Trades skipped, and why (daily limit, licence, price moved).
- Problems, such as MT5 not responding or a settings typo, and when they're fixed.
- A daily summary at your chosen time: balance, equity and the day's trades.

Planning your accounts

The one rule worth remembering: **size your risk from the worst drawdown, not the best month.** Results are published in R, so your drawdown in percent is simply your risk per trade times the drawdown in R.

> Drawdown % = risk per trade % × drawdown in R

The table shows what drawdowns of 20R and 35R would mean at different risk levels. These are illustrative; use the current figures on the Results page of bayesiansystems.io, and remember a future drawdown can be deeper than any in the backtest.

Risk per trade	1R on $100,000	A 20R drawdown	A 35R drawdown
0.25%	$250	−5%	−8.75%
0.5%	$500	−10%	−17.5%
1%	$1,000	−20%	−35%
2%	$2,000	−40%	−70%

On a prop account, compare those numbers with your firm's maximum loss. A 10% max-loss account at 1% risk can't survive a 20R drawdown; at 0.25% it can.

Several prop accounts: some traders run higher risk across several cheaper accounts and accept that some will fail, in exchange for more chances at a payout. Whether that makes sense depends on challenge fees, payout rules and your own money; the calculator on bayesiansystems.io lets you try your own numbers.

These are worked examples of the arithmetic, not a recommendation for your situation. You choose your account size, risk and settings. If you're unsure, speak to an independent financial adviser.

Troubleshooting

Most problems show as a clear message in the bot's window, in `bayesian.log` next to the .exe, and on Telegram if you use it.

Message or problem	What to do
Could not connect to MT5	Open MT5 and log in. If you have several MT5s, set `terminal_path` in settings.ini or run `--setup`.
Algo Trading button is OFF / orders rejected (10027)	Click **Algo Trading** in MT5 so it's green.
Couldn't find DE40 (or another market) at your broker	Look up your broker's name for it in MT5's Market Watch and put it under `[symbols]` in settings.ini.
No price history / not enough bars	Tools → Options → Charts → Max bars in chart = 100000, restart MT5, wait a few minutes, run `--test` again.
Licence key not recognised	Copy the key again from your Whop orders page; it must match exactly.
Licence is active on another MT5 account	Start the bot on the account you want and type **Y** to move it.
Subscription not active	Check your payment in Whop. New trades resume within 5 minutes of it being active.
Free trials run on broker demo accounts only	Log MT5 in to a broker demo account for the trial.
Licence server unreachable	Check the VPS's internet. The bot keeps trading for 24 hours meanwhile.

Message or problem	What to do
Licence reply could not be verified	The VPS clock is wrong. Windows Settings → Time → Sync now.
Settings change ignored	The message says which line is wrong. Fix it in settings.ini and save.
Skipped: price moved / signal too old / daily limit	Normal safety rules working, not a fault.
Windows protected your PC	Click More info → Run anyway.
Browser says the file isn't commonly downloaded	Ctrl + J → … next to the file → Keep → Show more → Keep anyway.
The bot window closed	Run the .exe again. To start it after every reboot, run `--install-startup` once.

Still stuck? Run `BayesianSystems.exe --test` and send the output, plus the last lines of `bayesian.log`, to support.

Support and risk warning

Support: contact@bayesiansystems.io. Include your MT5 account number and broker, the output of `--test`, and the last lines of `bayesian.log`. We help with installing, settings and errors. We can't advise which risk level or account is right for you.

Risk warning. Trading forex, CFDs and futures carries a high risk of losing money quickly because of leverage, and most retail traders lose money. Backtested and simulated results are hypothetical: they are prepared with hindsight and do not reflect real trading, slippage or execution. Past performance, real or simulated, does not guarantee future results. Bayesian Systems licenses software. We do not provide investment advice, manage accounts or hold client money. You are responsible for your settings, your account and checking that automated trading is allowed by your broker or prop firm. Full terms: the Licence Agreement, Terms of Service and Risk Disclosure at bayesiansystems.io.